ERASMUS+ LANGUAGE EXCHANGE

THIRD SENIOR HIGH SCHOOL OF SPARTA

Co-funded by the European Union

Greek ● Italian ● German ● French / Dutch

Target group: Grades 10–12 Greek students + 26 Erasmus+ students (Italian, German, Belgian)
Duration: 40–45 minutes Grouping: Mixed international teams of 4–6
Language focus: Only six survival functions: Hello; Thank you; Please/You're welcome; I don't understand; Can you help me?; Good night.
Main aim: Students use a very small multilingual repertoire for genuine social contact and host-family communication. Greek receives special emphasis because host parents may not speak English.

Learning outcomes

By the end, students should be able to recognise the six meanings, produce several of them in Greek, teach peers expressions from their own language, and use the phrases appropriately in short host-family situations.

Materials

Print and cut the 30 language cards (6 Greek + 6 Italian + 6 German + 6 French + 6 Dutch). Keep both Belgian-language sets until you know whether the Belgian group uses French or Dutch. Also prepare six simple situation prompts on slips or display them on the IWB.

Before students enter

1. Arrange mixed-nationality tables.
2. Put the six Greek cards face up at each station or distribute one Greek set per group.
3. Keep the Italian, German and Belgian-language cards sorted by language.
4. Write the challenge on the board: Learn it - Teach it - Use it.

STEP-BY-STEP PROCEDURE

1. Warm-up: Why these six? — 4 minutes

Tell students that some Greek host parents may not speak English. Ask: What are the minimum expressions you would need to be polite, friendly and able to ask for help? Reveal the six meanings only. Do not show all translations yet.

2. Greek Survival Challenge — 10 minutes

Give each mixed team the six Greek cards.
Model each expression once. Students repeat naturally, then practise in pairs. The pronunciation line is a support, not a test of perfect Greek pronunciation.
Greek students act as pronunciation coaches. Quick retrieval: call out a situation rather than the English phrase.
Example: "Your host mother gives you dinner." Students raise Ευχαριστώ!
"You cannot understand your host father." They raise Δεν καταλαβαίνω.

3. Teach Us Your Language — 10 minutes

Give Italian students the Italian cards, German students the German cards, and Belgian students the appropriate French or Dutch cards. Students become the experts. Each national group teaches the same six meanings to the others, but do not insist that everyone memorise all 30 forms. The goal is exposure, comparison and successful attempts.
Rule: the learner must say the expression back to the student-teacher before the card can be placed face up in the middle of the table.

4. Find the Meaning — 6 minutes

Mix the language cards. One student draws a card and reads it aloud. Teammates identify which of the six meanings it expresses. Award 1 point for the correct meaning and 1 bonus point if someone can respond appropriately in another language.

5. Host-Family Mini Missions — 8 minutes

Funded by the European Union. Views and opinions expressed are, however, those of the author(s) only and do not necessarily reflect those of the European Union or the State Scholarships Foundation (IKY). Neither the European Union nor the granting authority can be held responsible for them.

Read or display one situation at a time. Teams choose and say an appropriate phrase. Encourage Greek first when the imaginary host parent is Greek. Situation
Expected function
You arrive at the host family's home.
Hello!
Your host parent gives you dinner.
Thank you!
You ask politely for something / respond to thanks.
Please / You're welcome
Your host parent says something you cannot follow.
I don't understand.
You cannot find something and need assistance.
Can you help me?
You are going to bed.
Good night!

6. Final Multilingual Challenge — 5 minutes

Each team creates a 20–30 second micro-dialogue using at least three of the six meanings and at least three languages. One of those languages must be Greek. English may be used only to bridge gaps. Invite 2–3 teams to perform.

7. Exit challenge — 2 minutes

Before leaving, every visiting student says one Greek expression to a Greek student without reading it. Encourage them to use at least three Greek expressions with their host family that evening.

TEACHER NOTES

Keep the focus narrow

Do not add extra vocabulary during this workshop. Repetition of six useful meanings is a strength: students meet the same communicative functions across languages and can notice similarities and differences without overload.

Do students need to memorise every language?

No. Visiting students should leave with the strongest recall of the Greek set because they can use it immediately with host families. Greek students gain exposure to Italian, German and French/Dutch and should be able to reproduce a few expressions, but complete five-language memorisation is not the objective.

Pronunciation

The Greek cards include an accessible Latin-letter pronunciation cue because Greek uses a different alphabet. Treat it as scaffolding. Let Greek students model natural pronunciation and accept approximations that are intelligible and respectful.

Belgian team

Bring both the French and Dutch sets. Once you know the Belgian students' language, use that set as the main one. If both languages are represented, keep both and let the Belgian students choose which they teach.

Suggested assessment

Use observation rather than a formal test. Success means that students: (a) participate, (b) attempt unfamiliar languages, (c) select a phrase appropriate to a situation, and (d) can produce at least three Greek expressions by the end.

Optional follow-up at the host home

Ask visiting students to use three Greek phrases that evening and report the next morning which phrase produced the warmest or most useful interaction. This keeps the task authentic without adding homework-like pressure.

Funded by the European Union. Views and opinions expressed are, however, those of the author(s) only and do not necessarily reflect those of the European Union or the State Scholarships Foundation (IKY). Neither the European Union nor the granting authority can be held responsible for them.

ERASMUS LANGUAGE EXCHANGE - GREEK

HELLO!

Γεια σας!

ya sas!

Greek • Erasmus Survival Phrase

THANK YOU!

Ευχαριστώ!

ef-ha-ri-STO!

Greek • Erasmus Survival Phrase

PLEASE / YOU'RE WELCOME

Παρακαλώ.

pa-ra-ka-LO!

Greek • Erasmus Survival Phrase

I DON'T UNDERSTAND.

Δεν καταλαβαίνω.

then ka-ta-la-VE-no!

Greek • Erasmus Survival Phrase

CAN YOU HELP ME?

Μπορείτε να με βοηθήσετε;

bo-REE-te na me vo-ee-THI-se-te?

Greek • Erasmus Survival Phrase

GOOD NIGHT!

Καληνύχτα!

ka-lee-NEEKH-ta!

Greek • Erasmus Survival Phrase

Cut along the card edges. Whimsical hand-painted animation-inspired classroom design.

ERASMUS LANGUAGE EXCHANGE - ITALIAN

HELLO!

Ciao!

Italian • Erasmus Survival Phrase

THANK YOU!

Grazie!

Italian • Erasmus Survival Phrase

PLEASE / YOU'RE WELCOME

Per favore / Prego.

Italian • Erasmus Survival Phrase

I DON'T UNDERSTAND.

Non capisco.

Italian • Erasmus Survival Phrase

CAN YOU HELP ME?

Può aiutarmi?

Italian • Erasmus Survival Phrase

GOOD NIGHT!

Buonanotte!

Italian • Erasmus Survival Phrase

Cut along the card edges. Whimsical hand-painted animation-inspired classroom design.

ERASMUS LANGUAGE EXCHANGE - GERMAN

HELLO!

Hallo!

German • Erasmus Survival Phrase

THANK YOU!

Danke!

German • Erasmus Survival Phrase

PLEASE / YOU'RE WELCOME

Bitte.

German • Erasmus Survival Phrase

I DON'T UNDERSTAND.

Ich verstehe nicht.

German • Erasmus Survival Phrase

CAN YOU HELP ME?

Können Sie mir helfen?

German • Erasmus Survival Phrase

GOOD NIGHT!

Gute Nacht!

German • Erasmus Survival Phrase

Cut along the card edges. Whimsical hand-painted animation-inspired classroom design.

ERASMUS LANGUAGE EXCHANGE - FRENCH

HELLO!

Bonjour !

French • Erasmus Survival Phrase

THANK YOU!

Merci !

French • Erasmus Survival Phrase

PLEASE / YOU'RE WELCOME

S'il vous plaît / De rien.

French • Erasmus Survival Phrase

I DON'T UNDERSTAND.

Je ne comprends pas.

French • Erasmus Survival Phrase

CAN YOU HELP ME?

Pouvez-vous m'aider ?

French • Erasmus Survival Phrase

GOOD NIGHT!

Bonne nuit !

French • Erasmus Survival Phrase

Cut along the card edges. Whimsical hand-painted animation-inspired classroom design.

ERASMUS LANGUAGE EXCHANGE - DUTCH

HELLO!

Hallo!

Dutch • Erasmus Survival Phrase

THANK YOU!

Dank je!

Dutch • Erasmus Survival Phrase

PLEASE / YOU'RE WELCOME

Alstublieft / Graag gedaan.

Dutch • Erasmus Survival Phrase

I DON'T UNDERSTAND.

Ik begrijp het niet.

Dutch • Erasmus Survival Phrase

CAN YOU HELP ME?

Kunt u mij helpen?

Dutch • Erasmus Survival Phrase

GOOD NIGHT!

Goedenacht!

Dutch • Erasmus Survival Phrase

Cut along the card edges. Whimsical hand-painted animation-inspired classroom design.